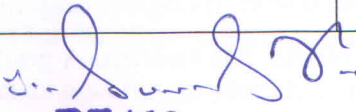
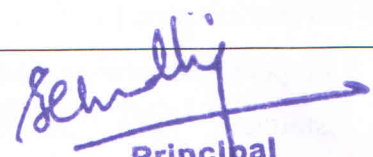


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Minutes of the 12th Academic Council Meeting

Meeting Name:	12th Academic Council Meeting (Hybrid Mode)		
Date of Meeting	30/08/2025	Time:	04:00 PM
Place:	Online		
Chairman	Dr. B. N. Chaudhari		
Member Secretary	Dr. Y S Rao		
Special Invitees and University Nominees	Dr. B. Satyanarayana (TIFR) Dr. Nutan Limaye (IIT Bombay) Dr. A. G. Keskar (VNIT Nagpur) Dr. M. S. Sutavane (COEP) Dr. Rajesh S. Pande (RKNEC Nagpur) Mr. Anand Chitre (Barclays) Mr. Aniruddha Ainapure (JPMC) Mr. Sudhakar Paulzagade Dr. Hema Date (NITIE Mumbai) Dr. Faruk Kazi (VJTI, Mumbai) Dr. Rohin Daruwala (VJTI, Mumbai) Dr. Vikas M. Phalle (VJTI, Mumbai) Dr. Hariram K. Chavan (KJSIEIT, Mumbai)		
Student Representatives	Amey Agarwal (CSE-AIML) Ronak Thakker (CSE-DS) Mrunal Jadhav (MCA) Omkar Rao (COMP) Rucha Kulkarni (COMP) Shruti Prabhu (EXTC)		
Head of the Departments	Dr. Reena S. Sonkusare Dr. Prasenjit Bhavathantkar Dr. D. R. Kalbande Dr. D. M. Patil		
Controller of Examinations	Dr. Sukanya Kulkarni		
T.P.O.	Mr. Vinod Sikka		
Registrar	Ms. Pallavi More		
Faculty Representatives	Dr R. G. Sutar Dr. Pooja Raundale Dr. K. K. Devadkar Dr. Aarti Karande		


DEAN
Academics & Research
Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan's
Sardar Patel Institute of Technology
Andheri (W), Mumbai-58.


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Sardar Patel Institute of Technology
Bhavans Campus,
Munshi Nagar, Andheri (West),
Mumbai-400 058.

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Professors and Associate Professors	Dr. D. C. Karia Dr. S. N. Dhage Dr. K. T. Talele Dr. N. A. Bhagat Dr. R. R. Sawant Dr. Sujata Kulkarni Prof. M. M. Parmar Dr. D. D. Ambawade
Minutes Prepared By:	Dr. Deepak Nair

The 12th Academic Council meeting was held via hybrid mode on 30th August 2025 at 03.00 p.m. to discuss various issues related to SP-IT academics.

Prof. Y.S. Rao, Dean-Academics, welcomed all the committee members and experts from across the country and thanked them for their cherished presence. He has briefed and presented the agenda of the meeting to the council.

The meeting highlighted the accreditation results for the Electronics and Telecommunication, Computer Engineering, and MCA departments, with varying durations of accreditation awarded. Discussions also centered on the implementation of NEP guidelines, specifically the introduction of mandatory multidisciplinary minors and adjustments to course structures, including the proposal for research honors and the scheduling of internship programs.

Agenda 1: Confirmation of minutes of the 11th AC meeting held on 23rd January 2025:

Matters Discussed:

Professor Y.S. Rao, Dean of Academics, provided a comprehensive briefing to the council on the minutes of the previous meeting. The council confirmed the minutes of the previous meeting and approved the revision of credit allocation for Indian Knowledge System and Universal Human Values courses from 1.5 to 2 credits. Updates on accreditation were presented, with NBA granting full accreditation for six years to Electronics and Telecommunication Engineering, three years to Computer Engineering, and two years to MCA, while the NAAC has awarded A grade to the institution.

The Board of Studies resolutions included the introduction of MDM courses from AY-2024-25, revision of the vision, mission, and program outcomes of the CE department, and modifications to the MCA program, shifting the Major Project to the third semester and Internship to the fourth

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semester with both extended to one year. The council endorsed these decisions while noting certain course discrepancies for review.

Highlights of the internship and placement reports for AY 2023–24 were shared, with students securing prestigious research and industry internships and the institute achieving 100% placements. The efforts of the Training and Placement Cell were highly appreciated.

A comprehensive overview of the MDM syllabus was presented and approved for phased implementation. It was decided that the courses would be free for SPIT students and offered to students from other institutes at a nominal fee of ₹6,000. Finance and management electives will be introduced in line with student demand, with strict adherence to AICTE guidelines. The council also resolved that MDM credits will not be included in CGPA calculations.

Dr. Rohin Daruwala raised concerns about the fee structure for courses offered by SPJM, to which Dr. B. N. Chaudhari clarified that essential credits required for graduation would not incur fees, although some optional courses might. The council also noted the enrollment of approximately 1,200 students across various courses, including a research-based honors degree program.

Dr. Rao shared enrollment statistics, indicating around 1,200 students in various courses, including 31 in Sanskrit and 56 in Humanities. The honors degree program by research has 15 students enrolled, with coursework focused on research methodology and internships.

Following a thorough review, the council unanimously confirmed and approved the minutes of the meeting.

Agenda 2: Information about the discussions and resolutions of respective BoS meetings:

EXTC:

Head of the EXTC Department, Dr. Reena Kumbhare proposed a revised course structure that included a tutorial and lab, leading to a discussion on the classification of the tutorial. The council emphasized the importance of clear definitions in course offerings. Updates on the syllabus for semesters 5 and 6 were presented, with discussions on program electives and curriculum organization. She also presented updates on the EXTC curriculum, detailing core and elective courses across semesters.

Reena Kumbhare presented a course structure that included a tutorial and a lab, prompting Dr. Rohin Daruwala to suggest that the tutorial should be considered a lecture since it involves theoretical content. Dr. B. N. Chaudhari highlighted the need to decide whether to teach all students together or in smaller batches, depending on the desired learning outcomes. Reena agreed to reclassify the session as a lecture to provide necessary foundational knowledge before the lab.

Reena Kumbhare provided an overview of the finalized syllabus for semesters 5 and 6, which includes a research industry internship and program electives. Dr. Rohin Daruwala raised concerns about the structure of elective tracks, suggesting that rows should be colored differently for clarity.

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Dr. B. N. Chaudhari emphasized the importance of aligning the curriculum with national standards and recommended reviewing the AICTE curriculum.

Computer Engineering:

Head of the Computer Engineering Department, Dr. Prasenjit Bhavathankar detailed the integration of NEP in the computer engineering curriculum, highlighting the need for consistency in project work across tracks. Concerns were raised about the absence of signal processing in the digital image processing curriculum, with suggestions to include foundational topics to better prepare students for advanced studies in machine learning and artificial intelligence.

Dr. Bhavathankar presented the new curriculum structure for the computer engineering program, which includes programming courses starting from the first semester and core courses in semesters three and four. He also discussed the program elective tracks available in semesters six and seven, covering topics such as artificial intelligence, network security, and data science. Dr. Rohin Daruwala contributed by emphasizing the importance of balancing project work across all tracks.

Dr. B. N. Chaudhari suggested that the digital image processing course should incorporate signal processing fundamentals, as it is crucial for applications in data science and machine learning. Prasenjit Bhavathankar noted that students are learning digital image processing directly, without prior exposure to signal processing. Dr. Avinash Gajanan Keskar and others supported the idea of merging the two subjects to ensure students receive a comprehensive education.

CSE-MCA:

Head of the CSE and MCA Department, Dr. Dhananjay Kalbande informed the committee that the BoS members of Computer Science and Engineering unanimously approved the NEP curriculum scheme and syllabus for TE and B.Tech., with detailed discussions and deliberations.

Resolutions:

Dr. Reena Kumbhare will adjust the course title from "Fundamentals of Antenna" and "Fundamentals of Power Electronics" to "Antenna" and "Power Electronics."

Dr. Kumbhare will change the tutorial component of the Internet of Things course to a lecture format.

Dr. Prasenjit Bhavathankar will ensure that the course structure includes a lab component for all program elective courses.

Dr. Prasenjit Bhavathankar will swap the Digital Image Processing course with the Quantum Computing course in the curriculum.

The committee suggested that in CSE all the MDM courses, MDM 4 subject should be capstone or

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subject only. This need to be discussed in the BoS meeting and also at department level meeting. In CSE elective courses, the committee suggested to rename Fundamentals of Signal & Image Processing to Digital Image and Signal Processing. The word 'Fundamental' should be removed unless there would be any advanced course in the same domain.

Agenda 3: Examination modifications (Proposed) and Result Analysis AY 2024-25:

Matters Discussed:

The Controller of Examinations, Dr. Sukanya Kulkarni, presented the proposed modifications in the examination scheme, effective from the academic year 2025-26, aim to streamline the assessment process for both undergraduate and postgraduate programs by ensuring fairness, reducing administrative burden, and discouraging malpractice.

She briefed that the academic year would follow a two-tier examination structure consisting of a regular examination and a consolidated re-examination at the end of the academic year, thereby abolishing the special examination.

Students with at least 65% attendance will be eligible for the regular examination, while those with 50-64% attendance will be required to pay a defaulter fee and attend a mandatory 15-day academic improvement program. Students with less than 50% attendance, those failing in regular exams, and those booked for malpractice will be permitted to appear in the re-examination after fulfilling the stipulated requirements.

A significant policy shift is the removal of blanket grade penalties for students who fail or are absent for valid reasons, with penalties now restricted only to malpractice cases. First-time offenders will face a one-grade penalty, while for second-time malpractice students will be declared year down and needs to take readmission and pay entire year tuition fees again.

The grade improvement policy has also been revised, allowing students only after graduation to apply for improvement in up to five program core or program electives, without any grade penalty and with requisite fees. For mid-semester examinations, no re-tests will be held, and absentees will be awarded pro rata marks based on end-semester performance, provided valid permissions or medical certificates are submitted.

Grace marks for specially abled students, will be applicable in every attempt until they pass the course. Overall, the reforms seek to enhance transparency, integrity, and efficiency in the examination system. Dr Daruwala pointed out that the reexaminations has no much of help in improving in the outcome of student performance. He highlighted the concern and the problem they have faced at VJTI regarding reexamination.

Dr Avinash Keskar suggested to award only DD grade to students caught in malpractices and also can ask them to reregister for the concerned course.

Dr Daruwala suggested that students should be given only 4 opportunities to appear for examinations of a

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course (including all forms of reexams). If he/she could not clear the course in 4 attempts, he/she must be asked to reregister for the course.

Resolutions:

The committee suggested to call meeting of HoDs of all departments and reach at a common consensus whether to have reexaminations after considering all possible merits and demerits in conducting multiple examinations.

Candidates will be allowed only two attempts for the end semester examinations per academic year, i.e.

Regular Examination and Re-Examination

Special examination shall be abolished from the academic year 2025-26 onwards.

The grade card of the students will have some markers, like '*' to indicate multiple attempts as there is grade penalties.

The committee agreed to allow students to appear for grade improvement only after graduation.

Grade improvement shall only be allowed for any 5 courses for 3rd and final year students. And this should only be allowed for core and elective courses only.

Grade improvement examination for any three programme core or program elective courses of their choice from the first, second year of the PG program shall be permitted.

Grade improvement attempts should only be allowed within two years for the graduated students.

Agenda 4: Information about the Internship Statistics AY 2024-25:

Professor Manish Parmar presented a comprehensive report to the council on the internship statistics for the academic year 2024-25. He emphasized the prestigious research internship opportunities secured by students at IITs and other renowned institutions. Additionally, he highlighted significant participation of students in industry-oriented internship programs across various sectors. The council commended the overall effectiveness and impact of the internship program.

Agenda 5: Information about the Placement Statistics AY 2024-24:

A comprehensive report on the placement statistics for the academic year 2024-25.

Reaffirming the Training and Placement Cell's commitment to excellence, it is assured to the council that continuous efforts would be made to further enhance placement opportunities in the coming years.

The council commended this outstanding accomplishment and extended its heartfelt congratulations to the institute on attaining a perfect placement record.

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Agenda 6: Approval (Ratification) for the Academic Plan (AY 2025-26-Odd term):

Professor Y.S. Rao provided a concise overview of the academic calendar for the odd term of the 2025–26 academic year.

He further stated that the Academic Calendar of First year is in the process of finalization.

Resolution:

The committee suggested certain changes in the plan which shall be incorporated and the plan will be updated accordingly.

The proposed academic calendar was unanimously approved by the council.

Agenda 7: Information about the Students Achievements AY 2024-25:

The academic year 2024–25 witnessed remarkable achievements by students across cultural and academic domains, showcasing excellence at both national and international levels.

From the Computer Engineering and CSE branch, students represented the institute in prestigious forums at state, national and international levels.

A significant number of achievements came from the EXTC Engineering branch also, with students excelling in academic competitions, particularly case studies, research, finance, and business quizzes at national and international levels.

Group participation was also noteworthy, with teams securing recognition at prestigious competitions and brought international recognition to the institute.

These accomplishments highlight the students' versatility, spanning cultural performance, academic research, business strategy, and financial analysis. Their consistent presence in competitions hosted by premier institutions such as IIMs, IITs, ISB, XLRI, and NMIMS underscores both the institute's academic rigor and the students' commitment to excellence.

The committee appreciated the students for their efforts and praised the institute for promoting and encouraging them for all such participations.

The Chairman, along with Professor Y.S. Rao, expressed gratitude to all members for their participation and valuable insights. They assured the council that all suggestions and recommendations would be implemented in the most earnest and effective manner.

The meeting adjourned at 6:45 p.m.

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